

reported in error can be removed, people may become impatient and look for a faster solution. Unfortunately, many times the answer they find is not legal.

Trent didn't think it was fair that the mistakes he had made when he was young would follow him around for seven long years. He was a college student now and felt much wiser than when he was a teenager. Trent had many late payments, nonpayment of a few accounts, and a repossession of his car all listed on his credit report. He had just gotten off the phone with one of the major credit reporting companies that had explained to Trent that you couldn't just erase negative credit history if it is true.

Although you can't remove information which is correct, you can fix any inaccuracies. Contact the major credit reporting agencies to fix the inaccuracy. If your understanding of the disputed information is different from the creditors and they refuse to remove the entry in dispute, you may include up to a one hundred-word statement in your credit report explaining your side. Thereafter, any creditor checking your credit report will at least see both sides of the story.

Unfortunately for Trent, all of the negatives on his credit report were legitimate. But he believed he had learned his lesson and shouldn't have to be penalized for mistakes of the past. Besides, how could he replace his repossessed car if he couldn't qualify for a loan? He worked the night shift at a health club and public transportation wasn't available at that hour. How was he supposed to get to work?

The solution appeared to him in a radio ad promising to repair bad credit. The advertisement guaranteed that for an upfront fee, negative credit entries would disappear. After Trent contacted the "fix-it" company and paid his upfront fee, he was instructed to obtain a tax identification number as if he was going to start a small business. He was to use this number in place of his social security number whenever he applied for

